

I am going to share a story from using the say-mean-matter model!

The first time I used **Say–Mean–Matter**, I could tell students were unsure. They kept asking, “Isn’t *say* and *mean* the same thing?” I modeled one sentence out loud, explaining that *say* was just what the text literally stated, while *mean* was putting it into their own words. That small think-aloud made a big difference. As they worked, I noticed students slowing down and actually talking about the text instead of rushing to an answer. The strongest moment came during *matter*—students began connecting the text to real-world issues and their own opinions. By the end, many students said the chart helped them understand the passage better, and I realized the routine gave them a clear structure for thinking without overwhelming them